

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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THE GOOD NEWS THE GOSPEL OF JESUS CHRIST IS GOOD NEWS.



In this reflection I want to place the emphasis on the TRUTH that the **gospel IS GOOD NEWS. IT IS THE GOOD NEWS – NOT BAD NEWS.**

THE CHURCH AND EVERY BELIEVER NEEDS TO REMEMBER THAT THE GOSPEL **IS GOOD NEWS** AND AS SUCH SHOULD BE SPOKEN OF - PREACHED - and TAUGHT IN THAT MANNER.

"GOOD NEWS" IS SOMETHING THAT IS POSITIVE, ENCOURAGING, AND DESIRABLE.

"The good news" (or "gospel" = "good spiel") is a literal translation of the Greek word **euangelion**, and the New Testament authors use this term to mean **the news of SALVATION, or LIBERATION** from sin, **BROKENNESS, and ALIENATION** from God.

In the New Testament, **"the good news"** is a translation of the Greek word **"euangelion"** and refers to **the NEWS OF SALVATION.**

WHAT IS THE TRUE MEANING OF GOOD?

In most contexts, the concept of good denotes the CONDUCT that should be PREFERRED when presented with a choice between possible actions.

Good is generally considered to be the opposite of evil and is of principles, morality, philosophy, and religion.

THE DEFINITION OF **GOOD IS DEFINED BY GOD'S WILL** meaning **the good** that is acceptable to God.

GOD'S GOODNESS IS A FOUNDATIONAL TRUTH OF SCRIPTURE!

And his goodness is praised throughout all scripture.

IN SCRIPTURE **HIS GOODNESS** APPEARS MOST CLEARLY IN HIS DEALINGS WITH PEOPLE. HE IS NOT ONLY GOOD IN GENERAL, BUT **HE IS GOOD TO US.**

HUMAN GOODNESS IS MODELED ON **DIVINE GOODNESS.**

HUMAN **GOODNESS** INVOLVES **RIGHT BEHAVIOUR, EXPRESSING ITSELF IN KINDNESS AND OTHER PRAISEWORTHY QUALITIES, INCLUDING AVOIDING EVIL, THAT COMES FROM THE INNER PERSON.**

THEREFORE:

ALL BELIEVERS NEED TO PLACE **MORE EMPHASIS ON THE GOODNESS** OF THE GOSPEL. **ITS GOODNESS** FAR OUTWEIGHS THE ALTERNATIVE OPTION which is the bad news.

THE BAD NEWS IS:

That All people have sinned and come short of God's standard of righteousness and all the world is guilty before God.

Therefore, all mankind is under judgment and destined to **ETERNAL separation from God.**

Estranged from being able to come near to God – strangers and aliens from God with no hope in this world.

All mankind was totally bankrupt of any righteousness and thus remained an enemy of God.

THE GOOD NEWS

The Gospel is God's message / announcement to the world and the church that He has graciously provided a way whereby MAN (we) can be freely accepted by God without the keeping of the law (10 commandments).

Where the sinner is **RECONCILED** to God through the death of Jesus on the cross and **JUSTIFIED** (brought into right standing with God) **through his RESURRECTION**.

My personal testimony

I struggled with condemnation, rejection and low self-esteem for years but Oh, the day that my understanding was enlightened and I fully realized that God was no longer angry with me – that I was no longer his enemy all because he had established peace between me and himself.

That God restored value, worth and identity to me and I knew who I really was as a person.

That this freedom I felt left a lasting impression on my life and has continued to do so until this day.

This is why I want to tell this great truth that still excites me every day. That very believer needs to value the worth of the Gospel – because it is the good news of Christ's salvation.

The Gospel is the good news about the undeserving sinner being **FREELY JUSTIFIED** and **FREED** from **JUDGEMENT** and is **NO** longer an **ENEMY OF GOD**.

Of God having **RECEIVED** us **INTO HIS FAMILY** calls us his children.

IT'S THE GOOD NEWS where our **DIGNITY, IDENTITY AND WORTH** have been restored.

Where **WE ARE NO LONGER WORTHLESS** but a person of value and importance to God and that I can be useful to him and his eternal purpose.

WOW – HOW GOOD IS THAT – Let all of us take a few moments to reflect on those amazing facts.

THE GOOD NEWS

Is about how Jesus destroyed the hurt of the grave and the fear of death.

How God removed us from the kingdom of darkness into the kingdom of his dear son.

Where we are no longer under Satan's control but Christ's.

THAT IS THE GOOD NEWS

IT IS NOT JUST NEWS – **IT IS GOOD NEWS** - That is how the gospel is described by the Bible **WE MUST EMPHASISE THAT FACT.**

LET US MAGNIFY THE GOOD NEWS – NOT MINIMIZE OR TAKE IT FOR GRANTED.

LET US HAVE A FRESH LOOK at what it means to be saved, sanctified, justified and reconciled through Christ's one act of obedience to God.

LET US TODAY ASK GOD FOR A FRESH UNDERSTANDING AND INSIGHT INTO WHAT THE GOSPEL IS AND ITS GRANDEUR because it is the most significant event that has happened in this world since the creation of the heaven, the earth and man.

Oh, how I like you to experience the joy, and excitement that I experienced when I finally "saw" the light of what the Good News really means.

THIS IS NOT THE NEWS OF SELF EFFORT; of man's **attempt to find acceptance with God.**

IT'S THE GOOD NEWS OF CHRIST'S SALVATION and all that his dying on the cross brought to mankind.

HOW BEAUTIFUL THIS NEWS MUST BE TO THE EARS OF THE UNDERSERVING SINNER.

LET US DECLARE, PROCLAIM AND TEACH OF THE GOODNESS OF THE GOOD NEWS OF CHRIST'S SALVATION.

AMEN - Ps Barry